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United Family

HDFC Bank, the country's second-largest lender that is in the process of merging with parent HDFC Ltd, is spearheading a cultural transformation to build a future-ready tech bank with a human touch

By **Anand Adhikari**

5 HDFC BANK TOP ATTRIBUTES

- FAIR AND OBJECTIVE POLICIES
- GROWTH OPPORTUNITIES
- FLEXIBILITY AT WORK

▲ **PEOPLE POWER** Vinay Razdan (centre), Chief Human Resources Officer, HDFC Bank

find a home for ourselves. We have found a home in our own family company,” said Deepak Parekh, Chairman of HDFC, when its merger with HDFC Bank was announced last year. In fact, Parekh, 78, had laid the foundation of the bank that is now taking over its parent company. So how does HDFC Bank plan to welcome the 3,900-odd people of HDFC Ltd into its home?

“It’s unlike any other merger,” says Vinay Razdan, Chief Human Resources Officer of HDFC Bank, the country’s second-largest lender by assets. “There is an umbilical cord, which has been present throughout because of the parent company. It will be an understatement to say that we are deeply conscious and aware of it,” says Razdan, who has previously worked at Idea Cellular, HCL Technologies, and ITC.

It seems the employees of the mortgage giant are certainly in good company as the bank’s success over the past three decades is the result of a happy workforce. While the integration with HDFC will start soon, the bank is already in the midst of a cultural transformation journey—“The HDFC Bank Way”, which is defined by six pillars: integrity, execution, innovation, humil-

ity, inclusion, and collaboration—to welcome HDFC Ltd’s workforce.

For the incoming employees—who are looking forward to joining the bank by June this year—the successful banking platform would be a big incentive. Razdan, who joined in September 2018, is already in the thick of things. In fact, the succession process of long-serving CEO Aditya Puri was well underway when he joined. And later, the Covid-19 pandemic struck. An amicable merger was launched just as the bank was emerging from these challenges. But, Razdan is completely focussed on making the